

BREAD, CLOTHES, AND
BROADBAND

Comparable To Water

In some state in the US—we forget which—the mayor of a city said Wi-Fi was a fundamental human right. The European Union recently said it thinks that Internet access should be made “mandatory” or something of the sort. And now this: the UN’s Conference on Trade and Development (UNCTAD) has said in a report that broadband Internet access “is becoming so vital for businesses that it can be seen as a new utility comparable to water and electricity.

“It’s absolutely necessary for countries because without broadband, it is difficult to have e-business,” said Genevieve Feraud, one of the authors of the Information Economy Report 2006. “Broadband is so important that we call it a utility which is just as necessary as water,

Just A Bunch Of Nutters

Pressure, especially with a special issue, is nothing new to us. Hardened by years of the stuff, when Fate tells us to jump, we just ask, “How high?”

But every now and then, even our finely-tuned cranial machinery experiences the odd burnout. Take, for instance, the unfortunate condition of our layout designers—Pillaiji, Vijay and Sivalal. It all started when Vijay overdosed on the barrage of advertisements on Internet Radio—Yahoo! Launchcast, to be specific. To this day (well after the cessation of said stream), he randomly chants, “No doubt about it!”. We won’t give out the advertiser here—they haven’t paid us.

And then there was the day Pillaiji discovered that if you hit [Shift] five times, your PC makes a very silly sound and asks you whether you would like to

enable StickyKeys. Needless to say, we were subjected to no less than ten minutes a day of alternating PC sounds and giggles. And Sivalal... well, Sivalal just is.

The rest of us succumbed to our own madnesses too—Nimish, Samir and/or Prakash would often be seen sitting at their PCs into the wee hours, getting their hindquarters fragged repeatedly by the wizened Raaabo. This despite Deepak’s impassioned threats of violence.

And the Browne made a boo boo again. Hot on the heels of last month’s gem, and in front of the entire team. The laughing shook the windows; “Oh, you’re so the subject of *Digit Diary* again”, he was told. And we wanted to tell you, really, but for the life of us, we simply can’t remember.

This pressure, it gets you right in the brain, it does.


 DIGIT DIARY

electricity,” she told journalists. Ms Feraud, what about e-business before approximately the year 2000, we must ask.

UNCTAD also did warn that the growing importance of broadband access is “disturbing news for the developing world.” Yes, it is disturbing us!

Any technology or telecom ministers or service providers out there listening? We poor slobs labour on with our less-than-256-Kbps connections, and weep on our pillows at night while asleep, dreaming of dedicated T3 lines. We want it. We need it. We. Want. Broad. Band.

Please be listening, Mr Telecom Minister and Mr Broadband Service Provider, to honest, law-abiding, tax-paying citizens! Even 3 Mbps in every home will do. We won’t complain after that, we promise... OK, how about at least 2 Mbps? ONE? Pretty please?

The eyes brim over. ■

Blog WATCH

So what are people writing about? Zune, naturally. And Vista. Web 2.0 also figures in this pick of blogs

Richard MacManus

<http://snipurl.com/dec004>

(www.readwriteweb.com/archives/yahoo_time_to_kill_off_web20_brands.php)

Yahoo: Time to Kill Off Flickr, del.icio.us and Other Web 2.0 Brands

...Yahoo could also try and re-brand Photos as Flickr, but that is a more risky proposition... If you look at how they’ve integrated RSS into their products - MyYahoo, news, mobile, email - they’ve done that extremely well and without scaring off non-technical users. Now, I’d love to see Yahoo integrate other ‘web 2.0’ technologies into their mainstream product range - Flickr into Photos, del.icio.us into myweb, etc...

Paul Roberts

<http://snipurl.com/dec006>

(<http://weblog.infoworld.com/techwatch/archives/008930.html>)

Is Zune the Next BOB?

Is Microsoft’s Zune turning into Bob? According to early press reports following the launch of the iPod Killer, it may well be. We all remember Microsoft BOB -- right? That disastrous effort to change the whole desktop GUI metaphor to something more cute and family friendly? Well, Bob didn’t go over so well and the project, plus its smiley face logo have become synonymous for ambitious Redmond projects that flopped.

RJ

<http://snipurl.com/11yn0>

(www.dailytechnobabble.com/2006/11/09/4-reasons-why-windows-vista-is-just-not-worth-it)

4 Reasons Why Vista Is Just Not Worth It

1. No new features or speed boost - No kidding, it’s true! Windows Vista won’t run Microsoft Word any faster, won’t make your presentations look any better, and if my own experience is any indication then Vista is not going to make managing your PC any easier either. If Microsoft sticks to their new anti-piracy plan then corporations will be having to setup whole new license management systems to deal with Vista...

David Haskin

<http://snipurl.com/dec009>

(www.computerworld.com/blogs/node/3964)

The future of Zune and iPod

...In order to enjoy the benefits, I put up with wretched, unstable software. And sometimes, the DRM software itself is balky and frustrating to use. Apple, but contrast, has made iTunes and iPods an easy-to-use unified entity. Now, MS has done the same thing with Zune. But it’s turned its back on PlaysForSure and is offering a closed ecosystem similar to Apple’s—with one exception: Users can either subscribe to music or buy it outright, an advantage over Apple’s buy-only approach...